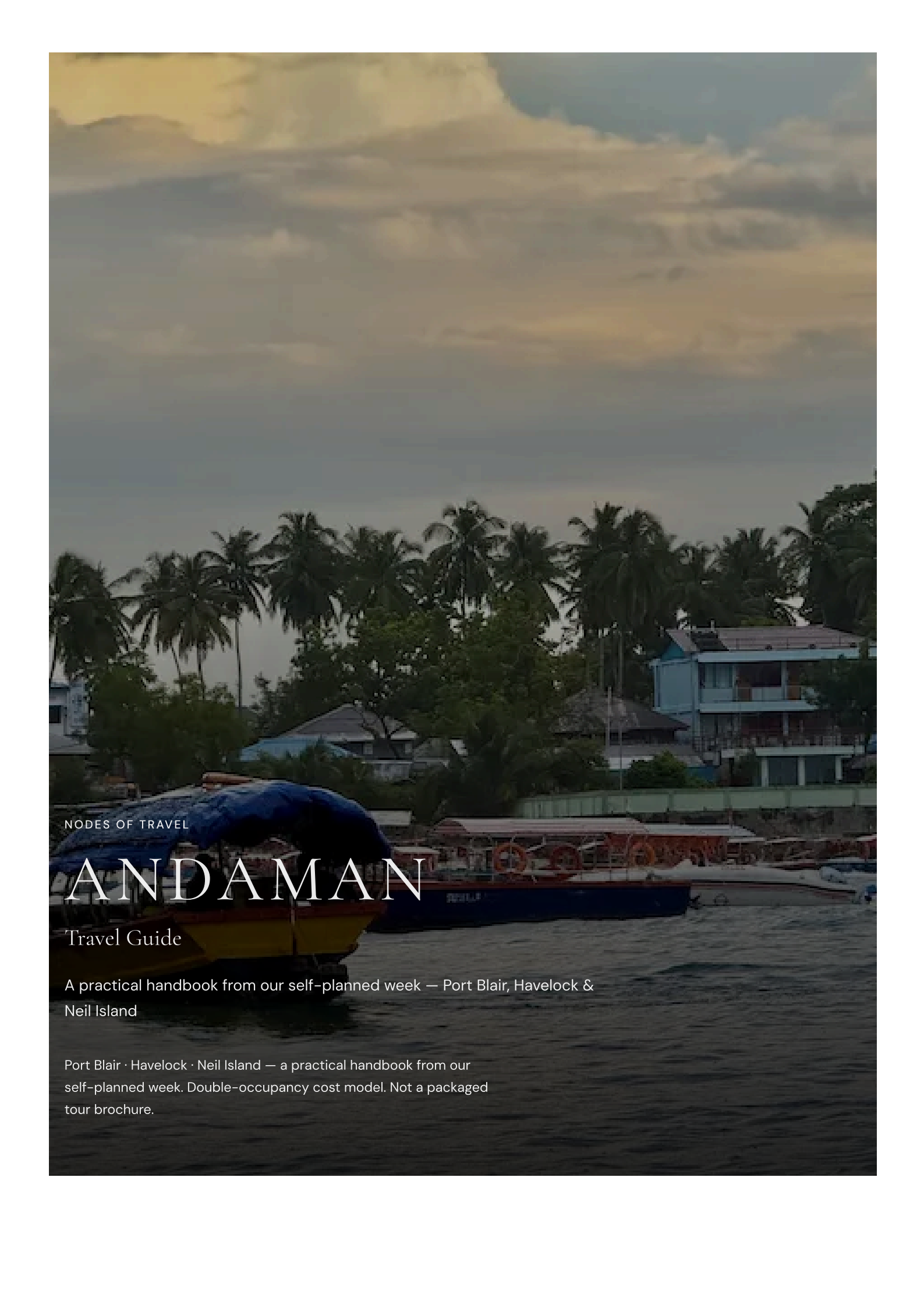




NODES OF TRAVEL

ANDAMAN

Travel Guide

A practical handbook from our self-planned week — Port Blair, Havelock & Neil Island

Port Blair · Havelock · Neil Island — a practical handbook from our self-planned week. Double-occupancy cost model. Not a packaged tour brochure.

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03 Before You Go

- Build flight buffer into day 1 — our arrival was massively delayed and stressful.
- Pre-book inter-island ferries; popular options include Nautica, Makruzz, and Green Ocean.
- For Havelock: plan an early Haddo Jetty departure (we left ~6:30am for a pre-booked Nautica Pro).
- Jolly Buoy: confirm season, permits, and book 1–2 days ahead — slots are limited.
- Jolly Buoy boats leave from Wandoor Jetty (~30 km from Port Blair).
- Stay near Aberdeen Jetty if Ross Island is a priority on arrival days.
- Keep a sunset backup near Chiriya Tapu — Munda Pahar trek was closed when we visited.
- Schedule Cellular Jail when you have emotional bandwidth; we kept the full visit for the final morning.

03B Practical Travel Notes

- Ferry tickets should be booked in advance, especially during peak season.
- Reporting at least 30 minutes before ferry departure is mandatory due to baggage scanning and boarding procedures.
- Jolly Buoy permits are limited and should be arranged ahead of time.
- Early morning ferries generally offer smoother sea conditions.
- Weather between November and April is considered ideal for travel.

04 Andaman at a Glance

ISLANDS WE BASED ON	Port Blair · Havelock (Swaraj Dweep) · Neil (Shaheed Dweep)
TRIP STYLE	Self-planned island hopping
OUR REFERENCE LENGTH	7 days / 6 nights
COST MODEL IN THIS GUIDE	Double occupancy (couple planning sheet)
PLANNER OPTIONS	7-day trip outline · 9-day with Baratang (+ Diglipur note)
FERRIES WE USED	Nautica Pro · Makruzz · Green Ocean 1
SIGNATURE EXPERIENCES	Ross Island · Jolly Buoy · Radhanagar · scuba · Elephant Beach · Laxmanpur sunsets · Cellular Jail
RECORDED DOUBLE-OCCUPANCY TOTAL	₹93,600
BEST FOR	Travelers who want beaches + history + water activities without a packaged tour

Our take — Free films and our blog give you the feeling of the islands. This guide is for decisions — where to base, which ferry, what to book ahead, how a couple-budget week spent, and how to shape 7 or 9 days.

05 Port Blair

Gateway hub — arrival/departure, history, and launch point for Ross Island & Jolly Buoy.



MAPPED STOPS

Total stops: 8 · Search place names in Google Maps

1	Aberdeen Jetty 15–30M Ferry point for Ross Island when staying nearby — we used it day one.	Maps: Aberdeen Jetty Port Blair
2	Ross Island (Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose Dweep) 2–3H Nature reclaiming colonial grounds; deer & peacocks; golf cart helps; lighthouse at the end. Ferry from Aberdeen Jetty	Maps: Ross Island Port Blair
3	Wandoor Beach 30M TRANSFER Road head for Jolly Buoy boats (~30 min from Port Blair in our run). ~30 min from Port Blair	Maps: Wandoor Beach Port Blair
4	Cellular Jail (light & sound / full visit) 1–2H Evening light-and-sound on our trip; full visit kept for the final morning — heavy, essential.	Maps: Cellular Jail Port Blair
5	Corbyn’s Cove 1H Port Blair’s main town beach — we used it on the finale morning.	Maps: Corbyn’s Cove Port Blair
6	Flag Point 30–45M Site tied to Netaji Subhas Bose hoisting the Tiranga on free Indian soil.	Maps: Flag Point Port Blair Netaji
7	Chiriya Tapu 1–2H Sunset area; Munda Pahar trek was closed for us — beach sunset still worked. ~15 min bus from our final hotel area. ~15 min by local bus from south stays	Maps: Chiriya Tapu Port Blair
8	Veer Savarkar Airport — Arrival/departure gateway — build delay buffer into day 1.	Maps: Veer Savarkar International Airport Port Blair

Our take — Essential as a hub, not only a transit night. Leave emotional bandwidth for Cellular Jail; pair Ross Island with an Aberdeen Jetty—convenient stay.

06 Havelock (Swaraj Dweep)

Beach and water-activity island — swimming, sunset, scuba, snorkeling.



MAPPED STOPS

Total stops: 6 · Search place names in Google Maps

1	Haddo Jetty (Port Blair departure) — Our Havelock sailing left from here — we aimed for ~6:30am for a pre-booked Nautica Pro. Early morning ferry check-in	Maps: Haddo Jetty Port Blair
2	Havelock / Swaraj Dweep Jetty — Arrival after ~2h Nautica Pro sail; Elephant Beach boats also leave from the jetty area.	Maps: Havelock Island Jetty
3	Kala Pathar Beach 1–2H Clear-water swim after arrival — we took an auto from the jetty side. Auto from jetty / hotel	Maps: Kalapathar Beach Havelock
4	Radhanagar Beach 1.5–2H Sunset beach — among the most celebrated on Asia lists we kept hearing on the ground.	Maps: Radhanagar Beach Havelock
5	Scuba (Havelock operators / dive sites) HALF DAY Our first dive: orientation + signals, then the dive — life-changing. Book a reputable operator on island.	Maps: Scuba diving Havelock Island
6	Elephant Beach 3–4H ~30 min speed boat from the jetty; snorkeling rivalled our scuba morning; boat scene can feel chaotic. ~30 min speed boat from jetty	Maps: Elephant Beach Havelock

Our take — Highest energy stretch. Expect early ferry mornings and chaotic-but-worth-it boats for Elephant Beach.

07 Neil Island (Shaheed Dweep)

Slow island — water colour, coral shallows, sunsets, downtime.



MAPPED STOPS

Total stops: 4 · Search place names in Google Maps

1	Neil Island / Shaheed Dweep Jetty – Makruzz from Havelock (~1h). Water colour at arrival is striking turquoise/azure.	Maps: Neil Island Jetty Shaheed Dweep
2	Laxmanpur Beach 1 (coral arch) 1.5–2H Natural coral arch at low tide; tide pools with fish and crabs — go around low tide.	Maps: Laxmanpur Beach 1 Neil Island
3	Laxmanpur Beach 2 (sunset beach) 1–2H Best sunset of our trip — popular and romantic. Often paired same afternoon as Beach 1	Maps: Laxmanpur Beach 2 Neil Island
4	Neil shoreline / resort beach stretch FLEXIBLE Private-beach mornings (hammocks, swing) and a quiet walk toward the sunset point — highlight of our stay.	Maps: Bharatpur Beach Neil Island

Our take — We loved Neil the most. If you want stillness, give it more nights than a pass-through plan suggests.

08 Must-Do Experiences

Ranked from what we actually did — not a complete tourist catalogue.

1. **Neil Island sunset (Laxmanpur 2)**
Best sunset of the trip.
2. **First scuba dive (Havelock)**
Orientation + dive — life-changing for us.
3. **Elephant Beach snorkeling**
Marine life that challenged the morning scuba.
4. **Radhanagar sunset**
Signature Havelock evening.
5. **Jolly Buoy (in season)**
Crystal water; book a day ahead.
6. **Ross Island**
History, wildlife, lighthouse — easy half-day.
7. **Cellular Jail**
Light-and-sound and/or full visit.
8. **Laxmanpur 1 coral arch**
Low tide paths and tide-pool life.
9. **Open-deck Green Ocean leg**
Ocean views + unexpected deck energy.
10. **Flag Point & Corbyn's Cove**
Close Port Blair with beach + Tiranga site.

09 Jolly Buoy



MAPPED STOPS

1	Wandoor Jetty (boat departure) TRANSFER + WAIT Maps: Wandoor Jetty Port Blair All boats for Jolly Buoy depart from here — about 30 km from Port Blair. ~30 km from Port Blair
2	Jolly Buoy Island HALF DAY Maps: Jolly Buoy Island Andaman Mangrove approach, glass-bottom boats, crystal turquoise; open seasonally; limited permits. Boat from Wandoor Jetty

JOLLY BUOY TIPS — BOOKING & RULES

- Permit requirement: a mandatory forest department permit is required (often included in tour packages). You can also arrange it at the Directorate of Tourism office in Port Blair.
- Departure point: all boats leave from Wandoor Jetty, about 30 km from Port Blair.
- Book 1–2 days in advance — slots are limited.
- Offline option: visit the Directorate of Tourism office in Port Blair to secure permits.
- No-plastic zone: all plastic items must be declared or left behind.

Our take — Fairytale water when open — treat seasonality, forest permits, and advance booking as non-negotiable.

10 Scuba / Snorkeling / Water Activities

Scuba (Havelock)

First dive for us: brief orientation and signals, then the dive. We would do this again without hesitation.

Snorkeling — Elephant Beach

~30 min speed boat from the Havelock jetty (can feel chaotic). Snorkeling quality rivalled our scuba morning.

Swimming — Kala Pathar

Clear water swim after arrival on Havelock; easy win with an auto transfer.

Jolly Buoy beach time

Beach bathing after the glass-bottom approach; water clarity was a highlight.

Neil shoreline / tide pools

Low-tide coral paths and small marine life at Laxmanpur 1 — slower water joy than scuba.

11 Ferry Comparison

We deliberately used three popular ferries on different legs — Nautica, Makruzz, and Green Ocean — so we could compare them firsthand.

Ferry	Leg we used	Deck	Our notes
Nautica Pro	Port Blair → Havelock (Haddo Jetty)	Closed deck	Newest of their fleet in our experience; smooth ~2-hour sail; pre-booked; early jetty start.
Makruzz	Havelock → Neil	Closed deck (white ferry)	About one hour; decent ride; similar closed-deck feel to Nautica.
Green Ocean 1	Neil → Port Blair	Open deck	Only open-deck option we used; roam for ocean views; upper deck became a Bollywood dance floor.

12 Where We Stayed

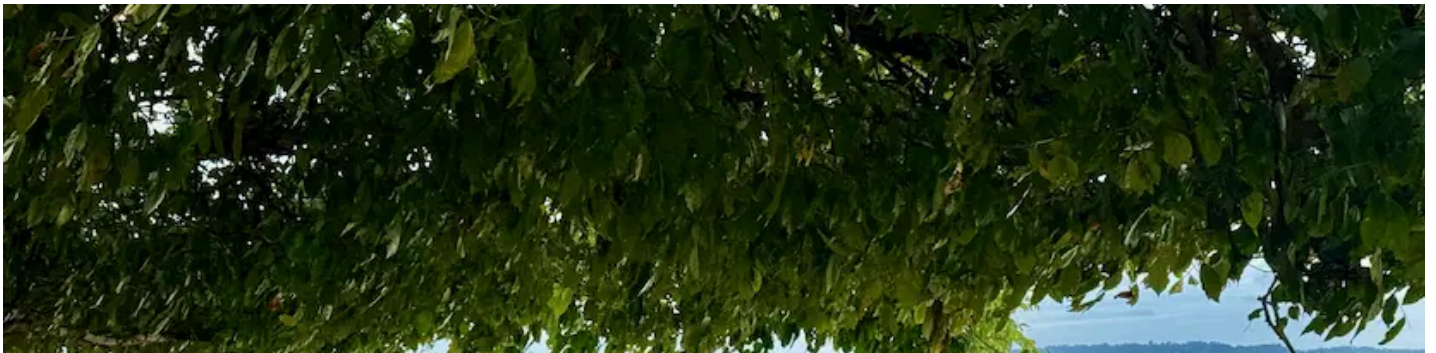
Stays we actually used — named from our trip records. Choose by island role (hub vs beach vs slow).



Port Blair — Hotel Star Paradise (arrival)

Arrival base with strong terrace energy toward the bay; convenient for Aberdeen Jetty / Ross Island days.

Maps: Hotel Star Paradise Port Blair



Havelock

Resort base for Kala Pathar, Radhanagar, scuba, and Elephant Beach days — plan dinner after long activity stretches.

Maps: Havelock Island Swaraj Dweep hotels



Neil Island — Tango Beach Resort

Private beach / pool setting, hammocks, slow mornings — favourite nights of the trip.

Maps: Tango Beach Resort Neil Island



Port Blair — Hotel Idhaya (near Chiriya Tapu)

Finale base near Chiriya Tapu for sunset; short hop to the beach; good for wrapping Cellular Jail / Corbyn’s Cove / Flag Point.

Maps: Hotel Idhaya Port Blair Chiriya Tapu

13 Getting Around

- Inter-island: ferries (see comparison) — treat jetty timing as part of the day plan.
 - Ross Island: ferry from Aberdeen Jetty; golf cart on the island made navigation easy.
 - Havelock: auto rickshaw for beach hops (e.g. to Kala Pathar).
 - Elephant Beach: speed boats from near the Havelock jetty — allow buffer for chaos.
 - Port Blair → Chiriya Tapu: local bus ~15 minutes from our final hotel area.
 - Jolly Buoy: road transfer to Wandoor Jetty + shared boat system with glass-bottom craft.
-

14 What We Actually Spent

Figures below are for a 7 days / 6 nights trip on a double-occupancy basis — the planning model we recommend for couples. (Our own family trip total was higher; this guide uses the double-occupancy sheet so numbers stay useful for most readers.)

BASIS: 7 DAYS · 6 NIGHTS · DOUBLE OCCUPANCY

RECORDED DOUBLE-OCCUPANCY TOTAL

₹93,600

BY CATEGORY

Flights (round trip to Port Blair)	₹30,000
Hotels (6 nights)	₹24,000
Food	₹6,500
Private ferries (Nautica / Makruzz / Green Ocean)	₹10,500
Cabs (airport, hotel ↔ jetty, etc.)	₹2,500
Ross Island (Aberdeen Jetty)	₹1,000
Port Blair sightseeing (Cellular Jail)	₹1,600
Jolly Buoy	₹4,500
Havelock sightseeing (Kala Pathar, Radhanagar)	₹1,000
Havelock — scuba	₹7,000
Elephant Beach water activity	₹4,000
Neil Island sightseeing	₹1,000

- Use as a real-world planning anchor — your season, hotel tier, and activity mix will differ.
- Ferry line covers three private-ferry legs at ₹3,500 each in this sheet.
- Hotel nights: Port Blair ₹3,000 × arrival/return pattern; Havelock/Neil ₹5,000 nights as logged.

15 7-Day Plan

CLOSEST TO OUR TRIP

Outline of how we actually moved — use as a booking skeleton, not a script to narrate.

DAYS 1–2	Port Blair · Ross Island · Jolly Buoy · Cellular Jail light-and-sound
DAYS 3–4	Nautica to Havelock · Kala Pathar · Radhanagar · scuba · Elephant Beach
DAY 5	Makruzz to Neil · resort beach · Laxmanpur 1 & 2
DAYS 6–7	Neil morning walk · Green Ocean to Port Blair · Chiriya Tapu · Corbyn’s Cove · Flag Point · Cellular Jail · depart

16 9-Day Plan

OUR WEEK + BARATANG

Same seven days we ran, then Baratang on Day 8. Honorable mention: with two more days beyond this outline, add Diglipur (North Andaman).

DAYS 1–2	Port Blair · Ross Island · Jolly Buoy · Cellular Jail light-and-sound
DAYS 3–4	Nautica to Havelock · Kala Pathar · Radhanagar · scuba · Elephant Beach
DAY 5	Makruzz to Neil · resort beach · Laxmanpur 1 & 2
DAYS 6–7	Neil morning walk · Green Ocean to Port Blair · Chiriya Tapu · Corbyn’s Cove · Flag Point · Cellular Jail
DAY 8	Baratang day trip — Jarawa Tribal Reserve corridor (strict permit/photography rules) · limestone caves / mud volcano area as offered
DAY 9	Port Blair buffer · any leftover Cellular Jail / Flag Point · depart

Honorable mention — If you have two more days after Day 9, add Diglipur (Ross & Smith Islands / North Andaman) rather than packing more into the middle islands.

17 What We'd Do Again

- More weight on Neil Island's slow pace — favourite stop
 - First scuba dive on Havelock
 - Elephant Beach snorkeling
 - Radhanagar sunset
 - Laxmanpur 2 sunset on Neil
 - Morning shoreline walk on Neil
 - Open-deck Green Ocean return
 - Ross Island + Port Blair terrace evenings
 - Jolly Buoy when in season
 - Cellular Jail visit (kept honest by placing it late)
-

18 What We'd Do Differently

- More buffer around inbound flights
 - Backup plan when Munda Pahar is closed (we used Chiriyapada)
 - Extra time allowance for Elephant Beach boat logistics
 - Treat Jolly Buoy season + prior-day tickets as fixed planning rules
 - Allocate more nights on Neil if stillness is the goal
-

19 Packing / Booking Checklist

BOOK AHEAD

- Flights with arrival buffer into Port Blair
- Inter-island ferries in advance (peak season especially) — report ≥30 minutes before departure
- Jolly Buoy: forest permit + book 1–2 days ahead (Directorate of Tourism / package)
- Scuba slot on Havelock if diving matters to you
- Stays positioned for Aberdeen Jetty (arrival) and/or Chiriyā Tapu (finale)

PACK

- Reef-safe sunscreen / sun protection for boat days
- Light cover-up for ferries and jetties
- Water shoes helpful for coral / rocky entries (Neil low tide, boat landings)
- Dry bag for speed-boat / rain surprises
- No disposable plastics for Jolly Buoy — declare or leave behind
- Comfortable evening layer for Cellular Jail programs

Packing items are practical suggestions grounded in what our days involved — not a sponsored gear list.

20 Useful Contacts & Resources

Names and places from our notes — verify current timings and bookings yourself.

Nautica Pro	Private ferry operator (we used Port Blair → Havelock)
Makruzz	Private ferry operator (we used Havelock → Neil)
Green Ocean 1	Open-deck ferry (we used Neil → Port Blair)
Aberdeen Jetty	Ross Island departures
Haddo Jetty	Havelock ferry departures from Port Blair
Wandoor Jetty	Jolly Buoy boat departures (~30 km from Port Blair)
Directorate of Tourism	Jolly Buoy permits / offline booking in Port Blair
Veer Savarkar Airport	Port Blair arrival / departure
Hotel Star Paradise	Port Blair arrival stay
Tango Beach Resort	Neil Island stay
Hotel Idhaya	Port Blair finale stay near Chiriyā Tapu
Free story (blog)	/blog/week-in-andaman
Free films	/videos#andaman-series
Destination page	/destinations/andaman

21 Final Nodes of Travel Recommendations

This free handbook is for planning — places, ferries, water decisions, real spend, and flexible 7/9-day shapes — not another retelling of our vlog.

Watch the films for emotion; read the blog for the narrative; download the PDF when you want it offline on the plane.

If you only have one bias to steal from us: do not under-allocate Neil Island.

Download the free PDF from the top of this page, or print from your browser anytime.

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Phone numbers, prices, ferry schedules, hotel rates, permits, and seasons can change. Verify with providers and official Andaman Tourism before travel.

Personal account from our trip — not a guarantee or endorsement.

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